

plausible prospect. When trying to incorporate nanotechnological advances into society, there are an array of items that require intensive study, be it the equity of disbursement, privacy rights of individuals and/or corporations, security considerations, the effect on the environment and the social and ethical impact on the human race.

Some interesting ethical questions are raised:

1. If nanotechnology can help us produce goods from inexpensive raw materials, shouldn't it be made available to all?
2. Should poor countries get the technology first? Before we start demanding self-replicating iPhones and laptop batteries that last a month on a single charge?
3. How will molecular manufacturing impact the global economy? Billions of people could lose jobs if the manufacturing process is perfected and made cheap.
4. What if we could live forever? Should we allow people to still have children? If we did, would we not become overpopulated quickly?
5. With nanotechnology, all of us would have to say goodbye to our privacy. Imagine floating nano-cams that fit and see through your clothes hiding in your bedroom or bathroom! Of course you could buy anti-spy nanobots to police your home, but that's just heading back to these days of cat and mouse being played with technology – the hackers vs. the security companies, all over again.
5. Finally, what about human enhancement? Will we cease to be human with all the nano-enhancements we'll do?

Research and news

Nanoparticles are now being widely used in cosmetics, electronics, optical devices, medicine, and in food packaging materials. However, research studies on the dangers and implications of nanomaterials continue to make headlines across the world, at alarmingly increasing frequency. Nanoparticles may well be the asbestos of the twenty first century: a considerable threat to the society.

As we already know by now, materials change their properties considerably on the nano scale and these changes can be exploited for our benefits. However not all changes are for the good. For instance, iron, at the nano level, switches its polarity using energy gained from room temperature heat, thus they are not useful for data storage, as had been hoped. Some nanoparticles crystalline structure changes when they get wet. So, numerous questions